

Question:

In research study, a mother and her infant are alone in a room. A stranger enters and the mother leaves the room. When the mother returns to the room, the infant begins to cry and initially continues to do so even after being picked up by the mother. Eventually the infant settles down and returns to playing, apparently happily, with the toys provided. Which attachment classification is most likely to be appropriate for this infant

Answer Choices:

- A. Anxious avoidant
- B. Disorganized
- C. Disoriented
- D. Ambivalent
- E. Dependent
- F. Attachment disorder
- G. Fearful avoidant
- H. Avoidant
- I. Anxious resistant
- J. Secure

Reasoning + Answer:

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- An anxious avoidant infant would show distress when the mother leaves but show little comfort on return .

- Disorganized attachment is seen with disorienting or contradictory behaviors .

- Disoriented attachment does not fit since it is a specific term describing behavior without this context .

- An ambivalent infant shows distress on both separation and reunion .

- A dependent infant is clingy and clings to the mother upon separation , so it does not fit the infant's behavior when the mother returns .

- A disorganized attachment would show behaviors that are confusing and inconsistent with the expected attachment responses .

- Fearful avoidant is the same as anxious avoidant .

- An avoidant infant will show little distress at separation and will avoid contact with the caregiver .

- Anxious resistant infants are very upset both at separation and reunion .

- Secure infants show a positive reaction to the mother's return and quickly calm down and resume playing .

The description indicates the infant avoids the mother when the mother returns , a characteristic of anxious avoidant or fearful avoidant infants .

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